

Deer velvet in S. Korea (2nd quarter 2023)

Reported on 14th of July 2023

1 Quarantine statistics of deer velvet from major export countries¹

1.1 Dried velvet

Dried velvet (kg)								
Country	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023 (~June)
New Zealand	33,554	61,815	78,410	44,535	37,811	24,369	39,655	29,378
China	68,902	61,972	74,117	69,716	77,990	72,634	89,569	34,994
Russia	34,275	50,989	42,132	46,450	54,042	55,986	43,896	7,106
Hong Kong	23,115	11,293	15,402	17,828	13,701	22,372	23,835	8,221
Kazakhstan	1,390	1,081	1,270	701	2,354	1,428	2,097	184
Total	161,272	187,198	211,410	179,782	185,931	176,842	199,086	79,893

1.2 Frozen velvet

Frozen velvet (kg)								
Country	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023 (~June)
New Zealand	88,922	64,809	81,365	99,113	77,477	91,874	116,584	86,130
China	22	68	6	10		2		0.2
Russia	3		3					
Total	88,985	64,900	81,380	99,124	77,477	91,877	116,591	86,130

1.3 Rolling year

Dried velvet (kg)			Frozen velvet (kg)		
Country	Jul 2021 - Jun 2022	Jul 2022 - Jun 2023	Country	Jul 2021 - Jun 2022	Jul 2022 - Jun 2023
New Zealand	30,772	43,946	New Zealand	110,224	125,867
China	70,369	95,042	China	1.1	0.2

Russia	53,491	48,474	Russia		
Hong Kong	36,171	12,471	Hong Kong		
Kazakhstan	1,784	1,925	Kazakhstan		
Australia	36	24	Australia	1.5	0.1
USA	5.1	2.9	USA	1.3	
Others	2.7	0.1	Others		4.7
Total	192,631	201,885	Total	110,228	125,872

2 Korean news

2.1 Gujeon, get ready for Family Month with the deer velvet gift set

Ahead of Family Month, high-quality health food "Gujeon Nokyeong" will hold discounts and gift events until May 31. If you purchase more than 500,000 won in total, you will be given a 10% discount coupon for all products and a 100% free rust product worth 140,000 won.



DongA Ilbo, 2023-04-26¹

2.2 PyunKang

PyunKang purchases Russian deer velvet with exclusive contracts, processes and produces them at the Jecheon plant which operated directly. Deer velvet materials were obtained from the 'Research on Suitability of Origin' and 'Quality Management System Certification'.

The winter of the Abaisk farm, which is the largest among Russian deer farms and has a 100-year tradition, is so fierce that it falls to up to -30 degrees Celsius. Deer endure the cold and their tissues become dense. For this reason, Russian deer antlers are called "wonyong" and are considered the best.

In 2022, data from the Korea Customs Service's "Import Price of deer velvet by Country" confirmed that Russian deer velvet were about **2.1 times higher** per kilogram than New Zealand deer velvet. **This is why Russian deer velvet are called "wonyong"**.



¹ <https://www.donga.com/news/lt/article/all/20230425/118997942/1>

DongA Ilbo, 2023-04-26²

2.3 hy (formerly known as Korea Yakult) signed MOU with CosmaxNBT

The two companies will cooperate in establishing a personalized health functional food business system. Hy is going to develop a product that applies the sleep health functional raw material "Ashaganda Extract" developed by Cosmax NBT.

Cosmax NBT is considering applying hy's **B2B** raw materials to **OEM** products in production. It plans to increase its marketability by applying raw materials for natural products such as probiotics strains, chikuppong leaf extracts, and **fermented deer velvet extracts**.



Maeil Ilbo, 2023-04-28³

2.4 Advertising on the excellence of Korean deer velvet

Nonghyup broadcasted 15 seconds of TVC for two months from May through YTN, a news channel. Beyond Nonghyup's product advertisement, it focused on promoting Korean deer velvet as a whole. It is expected to improve the image of Korean deer velvet and directly or indirectly lead to on-site sales through intensive promotion during the May-June period, when deer velvets are harvested. Nonghyup also conducted advertisements through cable channels from May to June last year and received good responses.



² <https://www.donga.com/news/lt/article/all/20230425/118997862/1>

³ <https://www.m-i.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=1009064>



The Korea Deer Times, 2023-05-10

2.5 2023 Deer Velvet Festival

From May 22 to 27, the 2023 Deer Velvet Festival was held at the Velvet Processing Centre near Cheongju City to mark the Korean Velvet harvesting season. It was co-hosted by the Chungbuk Deer Farming Association Corporation and Body-N-Yong Bio Co., Ltd., and co-operative by the Deer Cluster Project Group and the Cheongju Branch of the Korea Deer Association. In addition to various performances, there were cutting deer velvet cutting, tasting deer blood, and tasting deer meat bulgogi.



The Korea Deer Times, 2023-05-10

2.6 2023 Deer Velvet Academic Seminar

The Korean Society for Deer Velvet held a regular academic seminar at Konkuk University on June 16. Jeon Byung-tae, a professor at Konkuk University, speeches keynote with the agenda of "the value of deer as a medicinal animal." The Korea Deer Times, 2023-05-10

2.7 hy (formerly known as Korea Yakult)'s fermented deer velvet, published in international journals on the effect of improving muscle reduction in the elderly

Fermented deer velvet, which have increased the active ingredients of velvet through **lactobacillus fermentation**, are hy's own development material. Hy conducted screening of 5,000 strains held for the development of fermentation velvet. After first selecting 1,200 species, the process of finding surviving strains was repeated by inoculating them with deer antlers were repeated. *L. curvatus* HY7602, derived from traditional foods, confirmed that it has the best fermentation ability for velvet and was selected as a lactobacillus for velvet fermentation.

According to the proposed paper, hy studied **muscle atrophy** due to aging and the mechanism of action of fermented red ginseng. To this end, the researchers administered fermented deer velvet to mice aged 100 weeks. Four weeks later, the researchers measured the physiological changes in mice following their intake of fermented velvet and confirmed that they recovered up to 23.6%.

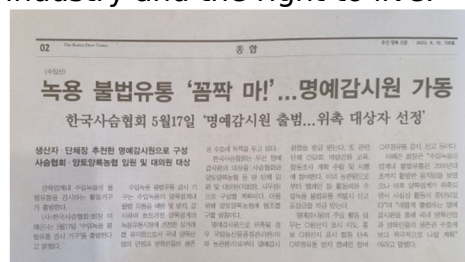


Chosun Biz, 2023-05-30⁴

2.8 Monitoring the illegal distribution of imported deer velvet

The Korea Deer Breeders Association has decided to form an honorary watchdog organisation to monitor the illegal distribution of imported deer velvet. The honorary watchdog plans to consist of executives and representatives from organizations such as the KDBA and Agricultural Co-op. It serves as a country of origin indication guide, country of origin indication crackdown, illegal distribution prevention campaign, and illegal distribution monitoring and reporting. Honorary monitors will participate in group meetings, capacity building education, establishment and implementation of joint investigation plans, and receive reporting rewards if illegal distribution is detected.

Cairman Lee Hae-gon said, "We plan to actively protect the domestic green industry and the right to live."



The Korea Deer Times, 2023-06-10

2.9 KGC's new branding for global market

Korea Ginseng Corporation has unified "Jeonggwanjang" into "JUNG KWAN JANG" in English to establish an identity that can be used globally

An official from Jeonggwanjang explained, "We changed the brand notation to 'JUNG KWAN JANG' by reflecting internal discussions and expert opinions because existing Korean and English are mixed and the English name is also used as 'Cheong Kwan Jang'."

Meaning of the best quality from soil to customer health by placing a simple straight line at the top of the brand, and provides the value of trust through strict standards. The logo also maintains the existing unique colour and simplifies the design that encompasses tradition and modernity, increasing the readability of the brand and continuing the image of Korean tradition.

The renewed brand design will be applied sequentially from some new products of Jeonggwanjang, which will be released this month. "In the future, Jeonggwanjang will be reborn as a global brand responsible for the health of people around the world," said Park Soon-young, head of marketing at KGC.

⁴ <https://biz.chosun.com/distribution/food/2023/05/30/A5JFX67RDFERJAF42JQBRJY5YA/>

JUNG KWAN JANG

Pinpoint News, 2023-07-03⁵

2.10 Rename to " Korea Pharmaceutical Zoological Society "

Chairman of The Korean Society for Deer Velvet Kim Soo-ki, Professor of Konkuk University, said at the regular general meeting said, "We are pushing for a name change within the year." So expanding research areas such as goats, insects, and marine animal consideration of environmental and food security. At the same meeting, "New Paradigm of Sustainable Eco-friendly Livestock Industry: Research Trends in Medicinal Animals Using the Latest Food Tech," "Activating Lactic Acid and Sustainable Agriculture" (Kim Cheon-ho, President of the Korean Heritage Association), and "New Food Resources Professor Sejong University" were presented.



Chuk San News, 2023-07-07⁶

3 News related with product launching

3.1 hy, Balwhi fermented velvet gelly stick

Brand <Product name>	hy Balwhi fermented velvet <Nokyong Bogam stick>		
Company/ Manufacturer	hy / Zen Food		
Volume and type	238g(17gx14pouches)	Price in KRW	49,500
Product category	Processed product	Other ingredients	Herbs and berries
Deer velvet %	Extract 2.5% (solid contents 20.5%)	Origin of velvet	New Zealand

Note: hy's patent lactobacillus used for velvet fermentation.



Hy launched the third deer velvet product. The main ingredient, "fermented deer velvet," is a natural material developed by hy. It is made by fermenting New Zealand deer velvet with lactobacillus. Through this, it is characterized by increasing the content of sialic acid, an active ingredient.

The new product is a jelly-type and stick-type packaging. Choi Young-taek, head of the health food CM team, said, "Balhwi Nokyong Bogam Jelly Stick applies strict standards from raw material management to product

manufacturing."

⁵ <https://www.pinpointnews.co.kr/news/articleView.html?idxno=204892>

⁶ <http://www.chuksannews.co.kr/mobile/article.html?no=255715>

Hankook Ilbo, 2023-04-05⁷

3.2 Cheon Ji Yang

Brand <Product name>	Cheon Ji Yang < Nokyong Hongsam Jinaek Hyun >		
Company/ Manufacturer	Health Balance Inc. / Huonsfoodience		
Volume and type	300ml (10ml x 30)	Price in KRW	22,900
Product category	Extracted product	Other ingredients	Red ginseng 0.15% And other herbs
Deer velvet %	Extract 8% (velvet 0.45%)	Origin of velvet	New Zealand



The "Nokyong Hongsam Jinaek Hyun" is a product made by combining deer velvet and red ginseng grown in clean New Zealand and domestic six-year-old red ginseng. In the case of New Zealand deer velvet selected by Cheonjiyang, they withstand the severe cold and have dense horn tissue. In addition, the entire process from harvesting to delivery and export is managed in accordance with the New Zealand Government's Food Safety law. The product is designed to consume both deer velvet and red ginseng per day, and 12 auxiliary ingredients such as angelica gigas root, jujube, licorice, Lingzh mushroom, Astragalus Root and

Lycium Fruit are also mixed. Health Balance sells a variety of products, including red ginseng, based on 16 years of know-how.

E2 News, 2023-04-24⁸

3.3 KGC, Cheon-nok Returning

Brand <Product name>	KGC Cheon-nok < Boosting >		
Company/ Manufacturer	KGC / KGC		
Volume and type	1,500ml (50ml x 30 pouches)	Price in KRW	220,000
Product category	Extracting processed product	Other ingredients	Herbs and berries
Deer velvet %	Extract liquid 1.8% (solid contents 16%)	Origin of velvet	New Zealand

Note: Claiming the velvet is 100% SAT grade.



"Cheonnok Boosting" released by KGC focuses on the physical strength of test-takers by containing deer velvet and red ginseng, as well as Licorice, Cornus fruit, and Rehmannia. It also

⁷ <https://www.hankookilbo.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=68794>
⁸ <https://www.e2news.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=253091>

neutralizes the bitter taste of deer velvet and red ginseng by adding seven kinds of berries' concentrates rich in anthocyanins.

KGC's CheonNok uses 100% of the highest grade (SAT) deer antlers guaranteed by the New Zealand government. The deer velvets are divided into a total of 30 detailed grades. Among them, the top grade is SAT. On top of that, the technology and thorough raw material management of KGC who has 8 patents related to deer velvet and more than 30 years of know-how in deer velvet research, were added.

Following the launch of "CheonNok Be-strong" in December last year, KGC strengthened the lineup of customized rust products by lifestyle by introducing new deer velvet products for test-takers. **"We will continue to meet consumer needs by developing customized products in the future,"** said Park Joo-yeon, head of the brand division of KGC.

Kukmin Ilbo, 2023-04-20⁹

3.4 KGC, Cheon-nok Returning

Brand <Product name>	KGC Cheon-nok <Returning>		
Company/ Manufacturer	KGC / KGC		
Volume and type	700ml (70ml x 10 pouches)	Price in KRW	100,000
Product category	Extracting processed product	Other ingredients	Herbs and berries
Deer velvet %	Extract liquid 1.29% (solid contents 16%)	Origin of velvet	New Zealand
Note: Claiming the velvet is 100% SAT grade. No red ginseng mixed in the products.			



KGC has launched "Cheonnok Returning." on 21st of April 2023 which containing New Zealand's top-grade SAT-grade deer velvet with a mixed concentrate of plants such as rehmannia root, angelica gigas root, peony root, white poria, licorice carefully selected for women's recovery.

Unlike the existing 'Cheonnok' products, it does not contain red ginseng.

In addition, women-specific materials such as mugwort, citron, jujube, and ginger have been added to

help women who have faced important periods in their lives, such as childbirth, childcare, and reinstatement, recover healthily.

Chosun Biz, 2023-04-25¹⁰

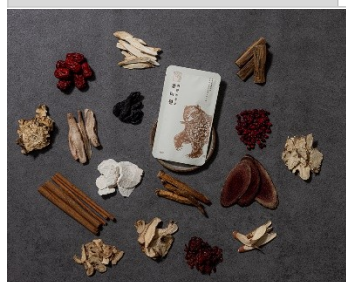
3.5 Woongbi

Brand <Product name>	Woongbiwon <Chimhyang Nokyong Bo>		
Company/ Manufacturer	Woongbi health center		
Volume and type	1,6000ml (80ml x	Price in KRW	59,000

⁹ <https://news.kmib.co.kr/article/view.asp?arcid=0924297675>

¹⁰ <https://biz.chosun.com/distribution/food/2023/04/25/ZADRBZQO5AQVG35ALXLT2I7I/>

	20)		
Product category	Liquid tea	Other ingredients	Aloe wood and many other roots
Deer velvet %	40mg in 1 pack	Origin of velvet	Russia



Woongbiwon pursues a distillation circulation extraction method that modernizes the three-bath method in which the effective ingredients of oriental medicine raw materials are properly extracted and the **traditional** full-bath method.

The newly released "Chimhyang Nokyeong Bo" uses 17 herbal health ingredients that can balance bile and blood and help immunity and health care and puts the sweetener in an aluminum standing pouch that is safe

for light and heat.

It contains 17 medicinal substances that complement each other based on "Sipjeondaebotang"¹¹, including Russian Wonyong, one of the world's top three scents, six-year-old red ginseng, and Korean rehmannia root, which is steamed and dried nine times.

Herald Economy, 2023-05-04¹²

3.6 KGC, Goodbase Black maca with deer velvet

Brand <Product name>	Goodbase < Black maca with deer velvet >		
Company/ Manufacturer	KGC / Pharmtec Korea		
Volume and type	300ml (10ml x 30 stick pouches)	Price in KRW	59,000
Product category	Extracting processed product	Other ingredients	Black maca extract, date extract
Deer velvet %	Extract liquid 1% (solid contents 0.5%)	Origin of velvet	New Zealand



"Black maca with deer velvet" is a liquid stick product that contains Peruvian black maca and New Zealand deer velvet. Peruvian black maca, known as the source of power for ancient Inca warriors, is good for men and is also called "Peru's Ginseng" because it contains rich nutrients such as 18 essential amino acids, 31 minerals and vitamins. It provides abundant vitality and stamina by containing 2,000mg of Peruvian black maca concentrate and 100mg of New Zealand deer velvet extract that has undergone rigorous quality tests by KGC.

Daily Hankook, 2023-05-09¹³

¹¹ Well known traditional medicine formulation by 10 kind of ingredients ([Reference link](#))

¹² <https://news.heraldcorp.com/view.php?ud=20230504000131>

¹³ <https://www.hankooki.com/news/articleView.html?idxno=76303>

Appendix I. Spreadsheets are supplied separately

Import statistics Korean import statistics for deer velvet.xlsx	Biosecurity pass recording not HS Code based trade records. Source is Animal and Plant Quarantine Agency (농림축산검역본부 ¹⁴)
Imports list Korean imports list for deer velvet.xlsx	Number of trade recording by food importers and products they imported. No volume or price of each trade but counting trade events. Source is Imported Food Information Maru website (수입식품정보마루 ¹⁵)
Food products Deer velvet food products in Korea.xlsx	Accumulated food product list over recent years. Based on various news article about product launching mostly supplied originally by the brand owner as a press release activity.

*To access previous reports please access [this online folder](#).

¹⁴ <http://eminwon.qia.go.kr/statistics/> (품목-국가별 수출입현황)

¹⁵ <https://impfood.mfds.go.kr/CFCCC01F01>